of Babur, the founder of the Moghul Sultanate. This appeared like an opportunity to Khwaja Ahrar. This union of the Abu Sa'id Mīrzā and Khwaja Ahrar was to prove decades long and fruitful for the whole kingdom. Khwaja had strong influence on Abu Sa'id's family. He had given name to Babur in his infancy as Zahiruddin Muhammad literally 'Defender of Religion'.

4 The Shahnameh or Shahnama 'The Book of Kings' is a long epic poem written by the Persian poet Ferdowsi between AD 977 and 1010. It is the national epic of Iran, Afghanistan, and Tajikistan. Consisting of some 50,000 *distichs*/couplets (two-line verses), it is one of the world's longest epic poems. It tells the historical past of the Persian Empire from the creation of the world until the Muslim conquest in the seventh century basing the mythical telling of the tale. Iran, Azerbaijan, Afghanistan, Tajikistan, being countries highly influenced by Persian culture apart from countries of proximity such as Armenia, Dagestan, Georgia, Turkey, Turkmenistan, and Uzbekistan celebrate this national epic (Bekhrad, 2018).

The work is of central importance in Persian culture and Persian language, regarded as a literary masterpiece. It is also important to the contemporary adherents of Zoroastrianism, in that it traces the historical links between the beginnings of the religion and the death of the last Sasanian emperor, which brought an end to the Zoroastrian influence in Iran.

5 Babur mentions his father as Turk here. It means that apart from Timurid identity of house ethically he considered himself a Turk.

6 The river Aras (Araxes or Araks) rises near Erzurum in Turkey and meets with the Akhurian River southeast of Digor. From Digor it flows along the Armenia–Turkey border, and then runs close to the corridor that connects Turkey to Azerbaijan's Nakhchivan exclave. It then continues along the Iranian-Armenian and the Iranian-Azerbaijan border (Iranica). Its total length is around 660 miles and its watershed cover an area of around 39,000 sq miles. The Aras is one of the largest rivers in the Caucasus.

Long ago, the Greeks called it Araxes (Greek: Ἀράξης). Its modern Armenian name is Arax or Araks.Historically it was also known as Yeraskh in old Armenian, and its Old Georgian name is Rakhsi. In Azerbaijani, the river name is Araz. In Persian and Kurdish its name is Aras and in Turkish it is Aras.

The Armenian tradition has named the river after Arast. He was the great-grandson of the celebrated Armenian patriarch Haik (Bauer-Manndorff, 1981). The name was later Hellenized to Araxes and was applied to the Kura-Araxes culture, a prehistoric people who flourished in the valleys of the Kura and Aras. The river is also mentioned in the last chapter of the Aeneid VIII by